

"As I came
to power
peacefully,
**so shall I
keep it.**"

CORAZON AQUINO, SPEECH BEFORE THE JOINT
SESSION OF THE UNITED STATES CONGRESS, 1986

THE PEOPLE-POWER REVOLUTION

Corazon Aquino chose to enter politics after her husband, Senator Benigno Aquino Jr., was assassinated in 1983. He had been a major force in opposing the corrupt Philippine president, Ferdinand Marcos. In 1985, Corazon declared her candidacy to run against Marcos for office. An election was held on February 7 and Marcos was declared the victor, but discrepancies between official reports and other sources made it clear that the win was fraudulent. Aquino and her supporters (including high-ranking members of the military) then ousted Marcos in a bloodless revolution, and Aquino was inaugurated on February 25. Here, Aquino is pictured calling for a national economic boycott and nonviolent action (to protest Marcos's attempts to undermine democracy) at Makati Municipal Hall in Manila, on February 8, 1986.

